SUBJ: Tampa ATCT & TRACON SOP

This order prescribes local air traffic control procedures and phraseology for use by Tampa Air Traffic Control Tower personnel on the VATSIM Network. This is not intended for real-world use. While this document is lengthy, most of the length comes from figures in the appendices.

Routes in this document have been formatted to imply their applicability in a few ways:

1. **Bold routing** requires the aircraft to be RNAV/RNP equipped and capable.
2. Blue routing indicates a metroplex route, which will require aircraft with updated nav data.
3. Gray routing indicates a *non*-metroplex route, which all aircraft should have.
4. ~~Gray strikethrough~~ routing indicates "legacy routing", which only exists in old AIRACs.

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1. PURPOSE

This order applies to VATSIM Air Traffic Control Specialists who seek to control air traffic at the Tampa Air Traffic Control Tower or TRACON. All concerned personnel shall familiarize themselves with the provisions of this order which pertain to their operational responsibilities.

2. CANCELLATION

This document replaces and cancels ZMA Directive 4, Version A, dated as effective on 12/16/2019.

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3. Clearance Delivery

3.1 Frequencies

3.1.1 Clearance Delivery (CD) – TPA_DEL – 133.600

3.2 General Responsibilities

3.2.1 CD controllers shall be familiar with SIDs, Valid Departure Fixes, and their groups. Further information can be found in Table 3 on page 3.

3.2.2 When multiple departure sectors are open, assign departure frequencies as follows:

North Operations	
Position	**Fixes**
D (118.8)	N+S
E (118.15)	E

Table 1 – Departure Frequencies (North Ops)

South Operations	
Position	**Fixes**
D (118.8)	N
G (134.25)	S+E

Table 2 – Departure Frequencies (South Ops)

3.2.3 Clear VFR departures out of "Tampa Bravo Airspace", and instruct them to "maintain VFR at or below 2,500". Create a VFR flight plan including aircraft type/suffix, origin airport KTPA, direction of flight, and intended VFR cruise altitude.

3.2.4 Assign IFR departures 6,000 feet or the requested final altitude, whichever is lower.

3.2.4.1 If the requested altitude is lower, inform the controller above you.

3.2.5 Unless otherwise requested by GC, instruct aircraft to push and start at pilot's discretion immediately upon correct readback of their clearance.

3.3 Preferred Routings & Altitude Constraints

3.3.1 Clear IFR departures via one of the following:

3.3.1.1 A current RNAV SID listed in Table 3.

3.3.1.2 LGTNG#/TPA# (as appropriate[1]), then radar vectors to a Valid Departure Fix (VDF) in Table 3.

3.3.2 Note: The SYKES# SID is no longer in use. Aircraft filing the SYKES# SID shall be taken off of that SID, and issued LGTNG#/TPA# (as appropriate), then radar vectors to a VDF.

3.3.3 For destinations listed in Table 4, controllers shall ensure all aircraft are assigned the specified routes and altitudes (unless otherwise coordinated with the affected controllers). Assigning SIDs to the stated first fixes is requested but not required.

3.3.3.1 Routes are listed in the table in order of preference. Controllers shall assign the first applicable route which the aircraft is capable of accepting.

"CLEARED TO DETROIT AIRPORT, ENDED9 DEPARTURE, THEN AS FILED"
"CLEARED TO HOUSTON AIRPORT, KNOST1 DEPARTURE, REMIS TRANSITION, THEN AS FILED"
"CLEARED TO ATLANTA AIRPORT, LGTNG3 DEPARTURE, RADAR VECTORS ENDED, THEN AS FILED"

[1] Assign LGTNG# to turbojet aircraft and TPA# to propeller-driven aircraft.

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SID	GROUP	VDF	NOTES
↑ KNOST# **↓ DORMR#**	N	↑ KNOST ↓ SYKES	North Ops: Use KNOST South Ops: Use SYKES
ENDED#	N	ENDED	
BAYPO#	N	BAYPO	
---	E	KNEED	To MCO/DAB & sats only
---	E	LAL	To MCO/MLB & sats only
CROWD#	E	CROWD	
GANDY#	S	SABEE	
---	S	SRQ	To RSW & sats only
LGTNG#	(VECTOR SID: JET AC)		
TPA#	(VECTOR SID: PROP AC)		

Table 3 – Valid Departure Fixes (VDFs)

DESTINATION	ROUTING REQUIREMENTS	ALTITUDES
KMIA & Sats	**SABEE FROGZ#** SRQ PALMZ# SABEE ~~**BAARY SSCOT#**~~ SRQ ~~*CYY CYY#*~~	AOB FL230
KFLL & Sats	**SABEE TEEKY#** SRQ FORTL# SABEE ~~**RXXAN JINGL#**~~	AOB FL230
PBI TRACON	**SABEE SHRVY#** SABEE PGD TTYLR# SABEE ~~**RSTAA WLACE#**~~ SABEE PGD PHK DCT KVRB/KFPR: CROWD TRV DCT	AOB FL210
RSW TRACON	SRQ **TYNEE TYNEE#** SRQ V579 RSW DCT	AOB 11,000
MCO TRACON (JETS)	**PRICY PRICY#** LAL MINEE MINEE# LAL ~~*COSTR COSTR#*~~ MLB Area: LAL V441 MLB DCT	KMCO: AOB 11,000 ELSE: AOB 5,000
MCO TRACON (PROPS)	KNEED ORL DCT MLB Area: LAL V441 MLB DCT	AOB 5,000
DAB TRACON	KNEED V152 OMN DCT	AOB 11,000
MYNN APP	CROWD ZFP BR63V ZQA DCT	---
MYGF APP + MYAM/MYAT	CROWD ZFP[2] DCT	---

Table 4 – PDARs & Altitude Constraints

[2] When destination is specifically MYGF, then "ZFP" may be omitted from the route (collocated with the airport).

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4. GROUND CONTROL (GC)

4.1 FREQUENCIES

4.1.1 Ground Control (GC) – TPA_GND - 121.700

4.2 GENERAL RESPONSIBILITIES

4.2.1 Ensure positive separation of taxiing traffic.

4.2.2 To the extent practical, prevent any undue delay to taxiing traffic.

4.2.3 To the extent practical, sequence departing aircraft by departure gate.

4.2.4 Ensure runway exits are kept clear and arriving aircraft are moved as soon as possible to ensure all exits are available to subsequent arrivals.

4.2.5 Ensure timely transfer of communications to the subsequent GC or LC frequency such that aircraft may continue their taxi without any undue delay.

4.2.6 When operating as Tampa Ground, do not provide ramp control services within nonmovement areas, except in a purely advisory nature.

4.2.7 GC areas of responsibility include all movement areas excluding runways. For further information on non-movement areas, see **Error! Reference source not found.** on page **Error! Bookmark not defined.**.

4.3 RUNWAY CROSSING COORDINATION

4.3.1 When requesting a runway crossing from LC, specify the runway and the point at which crossing will occur, using the format of "Cross [rwy] at [intersection]?". LC's approval indicates approval for only one aircraft to cross as specified, unless "...with 2" is stated by GC and read back by LC in the original crossing request.

4.3.2 When the traffic is clear of the runway, advise LC "Runway [rwy], crossing complete".

4.3.3 LC may grant GC "crossing blankets" for individual runways, which means GC may cross those runways without coordination with LC. If GC has been granted crossing blankets, and has an aircraft who will enter and cross a runway when landing traffic is within a 2nm final for that runway, GC shall announce to LC that they are "crossing [rwy]" about 15 seconds prior to the aircraft entering the runway. GC need not obtain acknowledgement by LC.

4.4 PREFERRED TAXIWAY UTILIZATION

4.4.1 W/V: Taxiway V is preferred for outbound traffic, and Taxiway W is preferred for inbound traffic.

4.5 MOVEMENT AREA TAXI RESTRICTIONS

4.5.1 Taxiway N, west of Taxiway L, is prohibited to aircraft larger than ADG4 (757/767).

4.5.2 Taxiway E, north of Taxiway J, is prohibited to aircraft larger than ADG4 (757/767).

4.6 RAMP TAXI RESTRICTIONS

4.6.1 Taxilane F and Taxilane R are prohibited to aircraft larger than ADG4 (757/767).

4.6.2 Taxilane T is restricted to aircraft with a maximum wingspan of 90’ (E145/CRJ7).

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5. LOCAL CONTROL (LC)

5.1 FREQUENCIES

5.1.1 Local Control West (LCW) – TPA_W_TWR - 119.500 (Primary: TPA_TWR)

5.1.2 Local Control East (LCE) – TPA_E_TWR – 119.050

5.2 GENERAL RESPONSIBILITIES

5.2.1 Ensure positive separation within LC assigned airspace (see Figure 2 on page 8) and movement areas.

5.2.1.1 LCW is assigned control responsibility for Runway 1L-19R.

5.2.1.2 LCE is assigned control responsibility for Runway 1R-19L and Runway 10-28.

5.2.2 Issue RVR information as required.

5.2.3 B757, Heavy, and Super aircraft are not authorized intersection departures for any runway when the full length is usable.

5.2.4 In the event of a missed approach or balked landing, LC shall coordinate headings and altitudes that will ensure separation from all other known/observed traffic, and advise the departure controller.

5.3 DEPARTURE HANDLING

5.3.1 All departures off Runway 10-28 shall be assigned runway heading and instructed to maintain 3,000. All Runway 10 departures require a release from S (south satellite).

5.3.2 Unless otherwise coordinated with departure control as described below, LC shall assign all 1L/1R departures runway heading, and all 19L/19R departures heading 210, with 6nm[3] in trail to each departure controller, constant or increasing.

5.3.2.1 When LCW and LCE are combined, all headings between the extremes of each may be utilized by the combined LC controller.

5.3.2.2 Obtain departure control's approval before assigning departure headings to aircraft on RNAV SIDs. This coordination is not done for each aircraft; only once for approval of the concept. Once approved by departure, LC may assign allowable headings to all departures without coordination.

NORTH OPERATIONS	
POSITION	HEADINGS
LCW	315-360[4]
LCE	015
LCW+LCE	315-015

Table 5 – Departure Headings (North Ops)

SOUTH OPERATIONS	
POSITION	HEADINGS
LCW	205-265[5]
LCE	190[6]
LCW+LCE	190-265

Table 6 – Departure Headings (South Ops)

5.3.3 Request a departure release from the other local controller by stating the word "REQUEST" followed by the DTA Identifier. As appropriate, use the word "PROP", "HEAVY", or "SUPER".

"REQUEST HEAVY CROWD" [...] "RELEASED" or "RELEASED BEHIND [callsign]" or "STAND BY"

[3] Remember, from the start of takeoff roll to the initial climbout, you will gain about 2nm of space from the previous departure. So, to achieve 6MIT, the next departure should be rolling when the previous is 4nm ahead of them.
[4] Departures to east fixes shall be assigned heading 015, and require a release from LCE.
[5] Departures to south/east fixes shall be assigned heading 205 (or 190 with a release from LCE).
[6] Departures to north fixes shall be assigned a heading from LCW's range, and requires a release from LCW.

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5.4 Land and Hold Short Operations (LAHSO)

5.4.1 Available landing distances are available on Figure 3 on page 8.

5.4.2 The below LAHSO operations are authorized in VMC only, between sunrise and sunset, provided that the LAHSO runway is dry, and has a tailwind component of less than 3 knots:

5.4.2.1 Landing 19L to hold short of 10-28 is authorized for LAHSO Group 6 aircraft (ALD 5650).

5.4.2.2 Landing 28 to hold short of 1R-19L is authorized for LAHSO Group 4 aircraft (ALD 4350).

5.4.3 Do not issue LAHSO clearances to any foreign air carriers.

5.5 Runway Usage

5.5.1 Unless the forecast indicates an imminent change, in wind less than 5 knots, north operations shall be conducted (landing and departing 1L/1R).

5.5.2 Intersecting runway operations shall only be conducted in VMC.

5.5.3 Use of Runway 10-28 requires coordination between LC and the affected TRACON sectors.

5.5.4 Preferred Runway Configurations:

5.5.4.1 North Ops: Landing 1L, 1R (ADG3 and smaller only[7]). Departing 1L, 1R.

5.5.4.2 South Ops: Landing 19R, 19L. Departing 19R, 19L (ADG3 and smaller only[8]).

5.6 Radar Tower Functions

5.6.1 Only controllers holding S3 certifications may perform radar tower functions at KTPA.

5.6.2 Except as described below, Local Control may provide complete radar services, including radar identifying, tracking, initiating radar handoffs and point outs, clock/distance based traffic information, and (to a limited extent[9]) radar vectors.

5.6.2.1 Only start a track for aircraft which you have properly established positive radar identification, and called the aircraft "radar contact". If they descend below radar coverage, they will need to be re-identified. For this reason, it is not appropriate to track aircraft remaining in the traffic pattern.

5.6.2.2 Do not track IFR aircraft, except IFR overflights through LC assigned airspace.

5.6.2.3 Do not issue any approach clearances.

[7] For noise abatement.
[8] For noise abatement.
[9] Aircraft should only be vectored for sequencing or separation. For example, vectoring for traffic is acceptable, while vectoring for an approach, or in the traffic pattern, would not be acceptable.

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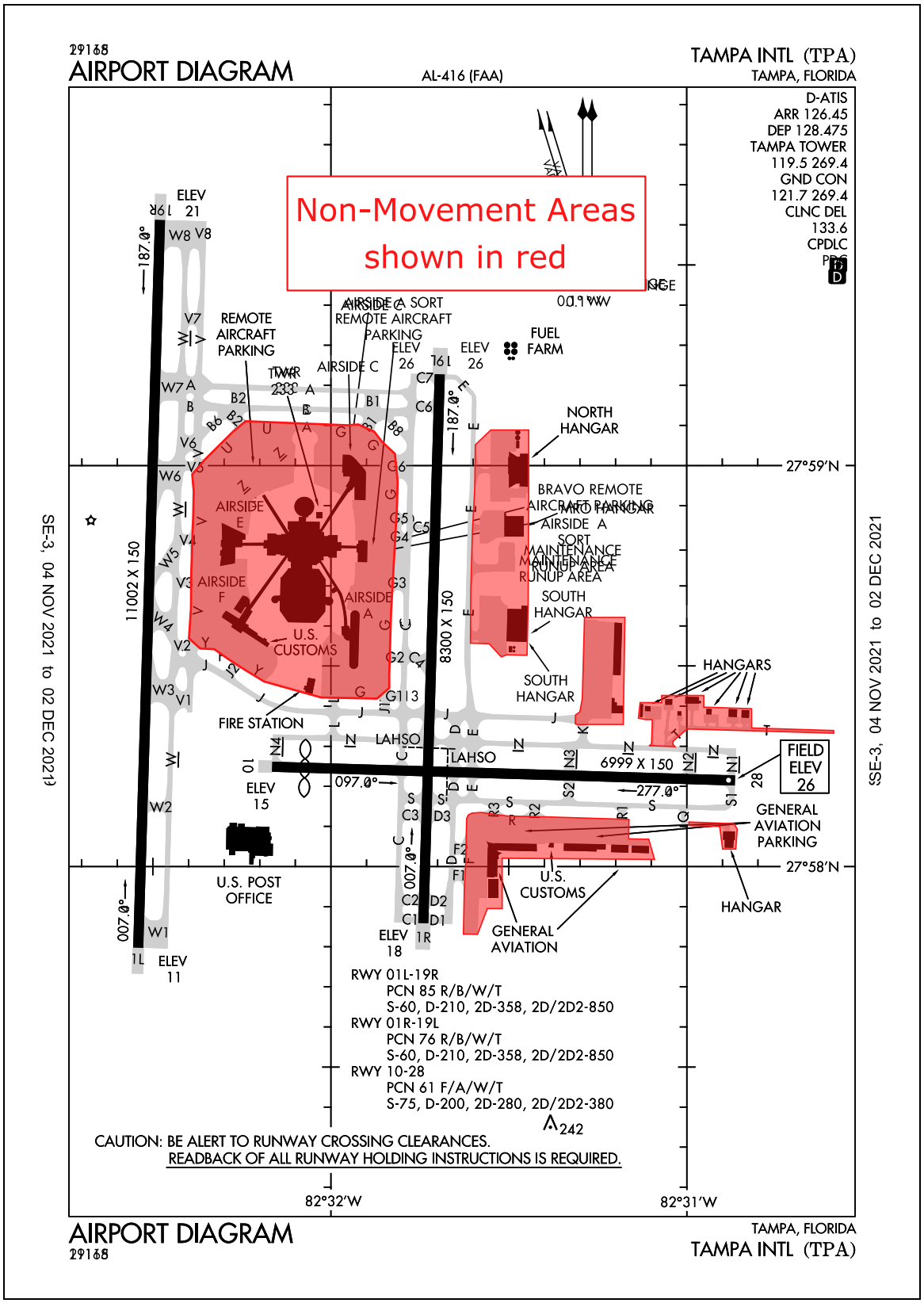

Figure 1 – Non-movement Areas

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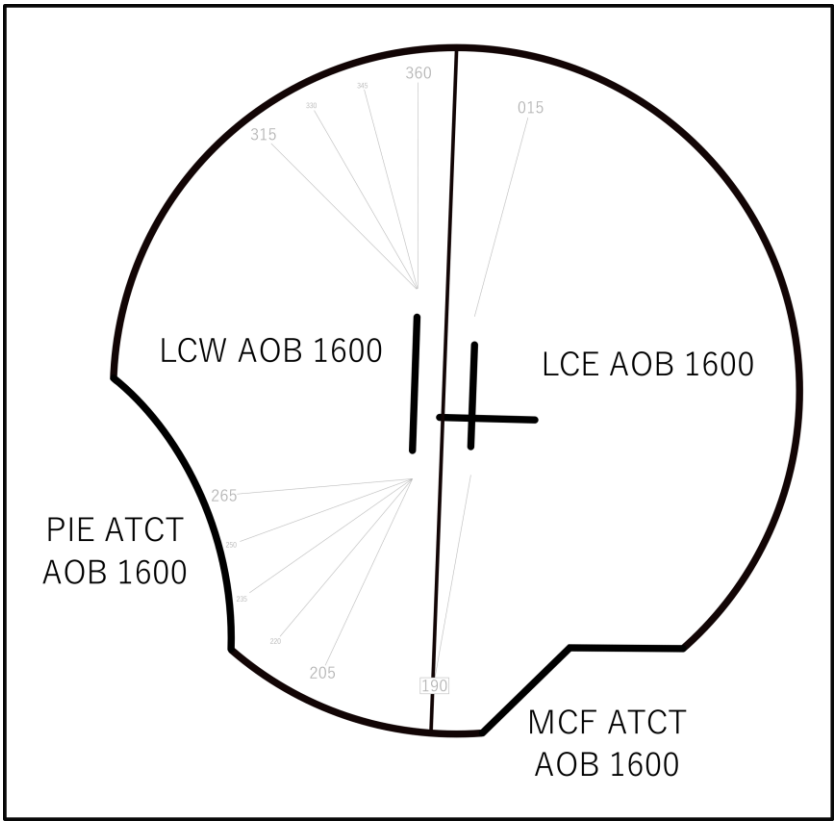

Figure 2 – Departure Dispersal Area and Local Control Assigned Airspace

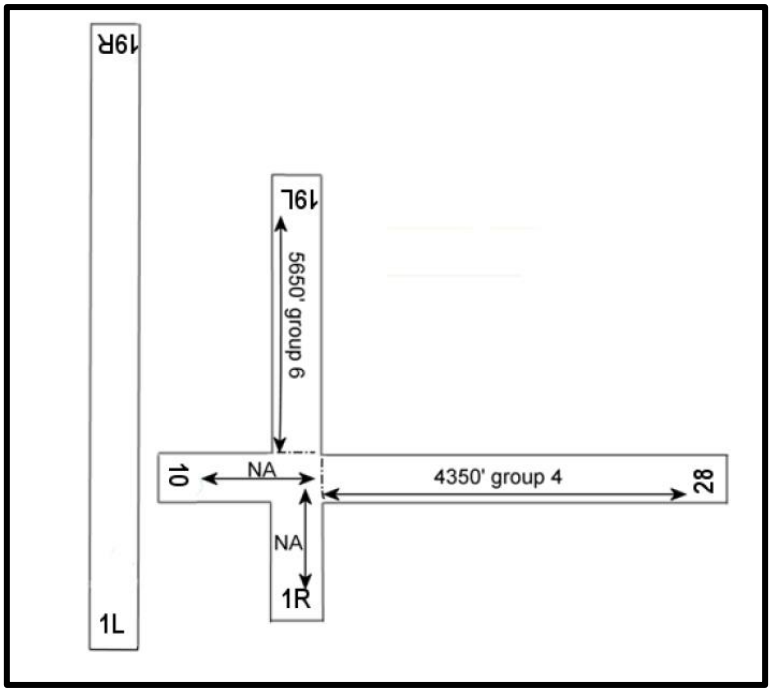

Figure 3 – Land and Hold Short Operations (LAHSO)

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6. Approach & Departure Control

6.1 General Information

6.1.1 The following nonstandard transfers of control exist with Miami Center:

Routing[10]	TCP	Control Type
KSRQ/KVNC via V97	ROGAN	Descent + L Turns

Table 7 – Nonstandard Transfers of Control from ZMA

6.2 East Arrival (E) - TPA_E_APP - 118.15 (Primary)

Works arrivals through DADES ATA, developing a feed for F. Also issues initial descents for TRAPR arrivals to Sarasota.

6.3 West Arrival (W) - TPA_W_APP - 132.52

Works arrivals through BLOND and DARBS ATAs, developing a feed for F.

6.4 South Departure (G) - TPA_G_DEP - 134.25

Works arrivals through DEAKK and ATA and departures out SABEE DTA. Occasional TEC traffic is seen routed over SRQ into the RSW TRACON, and over MURDO back from the RSW TRACON.

6.5 West Departure (D) - TPA_D_DEP - 118.8

Works departures through SYKES, ENDED, and BAYPO DTAs.

6.6 North Satellite / "St. Pete" (P) - TPA_P_APP - 125.3

Low altitude sector working traffic in and out of Tampa, Lakeland, and St. Petersburg area satellite airports on the north side of the airspace. Coordination with S is required before releasing departures or clearing aircraft for approaches to SPG (Whitted) or Peter O Knight (TPF).

6.7 South Satellite / "Sarasota" (S) - TPA_S_APP - 119.65

Low altitude sector working traffic in and out of Tampa and Sarasota area airports on the south side of the airspace. Coordination with P is required before releasing departures or clearing aircraft for approaches to SPG (Whitted) or Peter O Knight (TPF).

6.8 Final (F) - TPA_F_APP - 118.5

Issues approach clearances within delegated airspace for Tampa arrivals to the 1-19s, as appropriate. Transfer of communications to LC shall be completed no later than the final approach fix.

6.9 The "Lakeland Area" (not a sector!)

The Lakeland Area is a section of airspace which is traded among adjacent approach control sectors based on workload. Commonly, the controller working either E (East Feeder) or G (South Departure) will have the Lakeland Area, and they may trade it back and forth as necessary to equalize controller workload. These transfers need not be coordinated with ZJX, ZMA, JAX ATCT, or F11 if the controller holding te Lakeland Area deems such coordination to be unnecessary.

[10] All non-RNAV, prop, or legacy STARs/routes being exchanged between ZMA and TPA in the same area as the described are also granted the same transfers of control. For example, BRDGE DCT, ROGAN DCT, or LBV PIE would all be granted the same transfers of control as V97.

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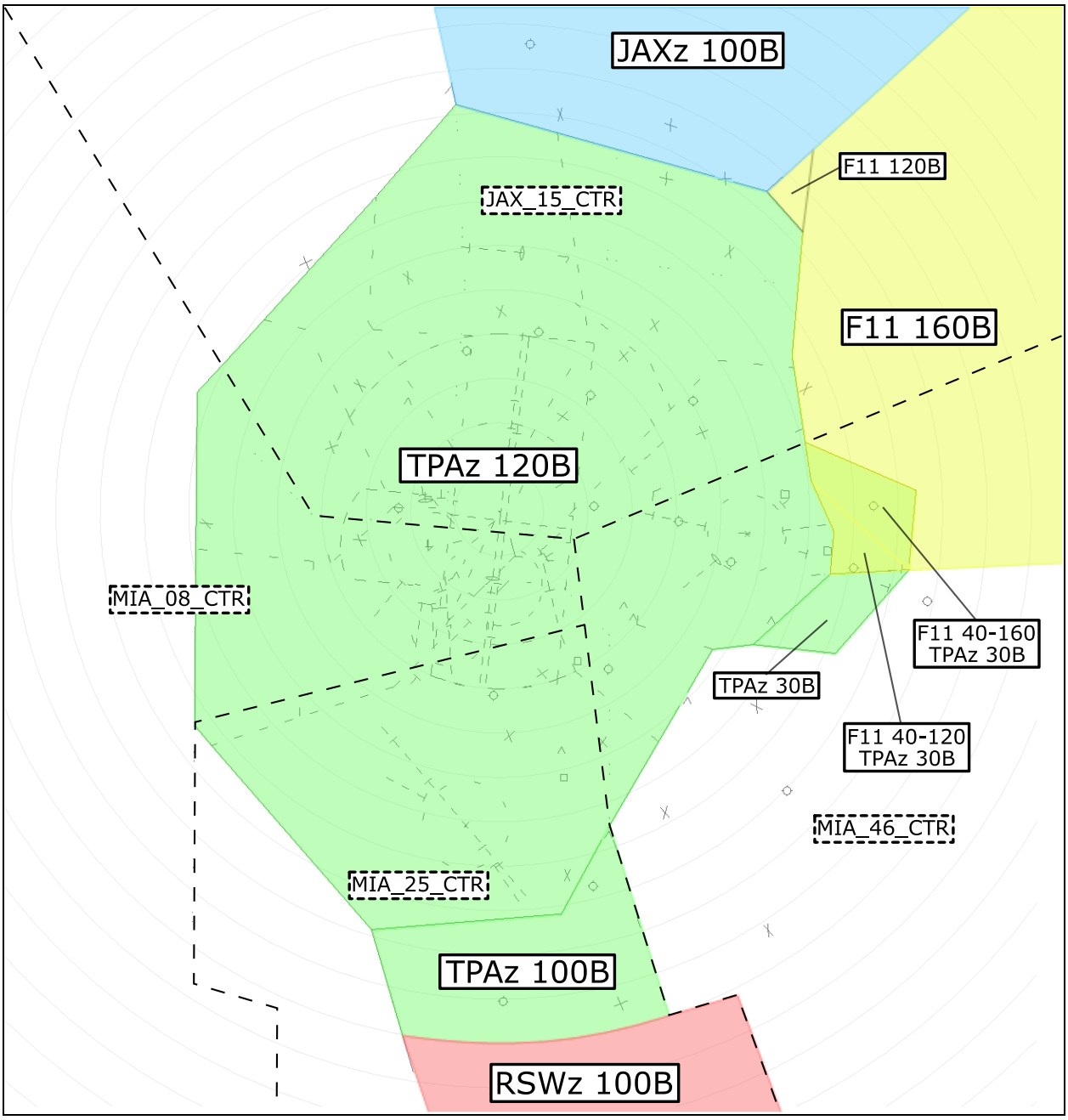

Figure 4 - *Tampa TRACON Airspace*

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Figure 5 – Lakeland Area

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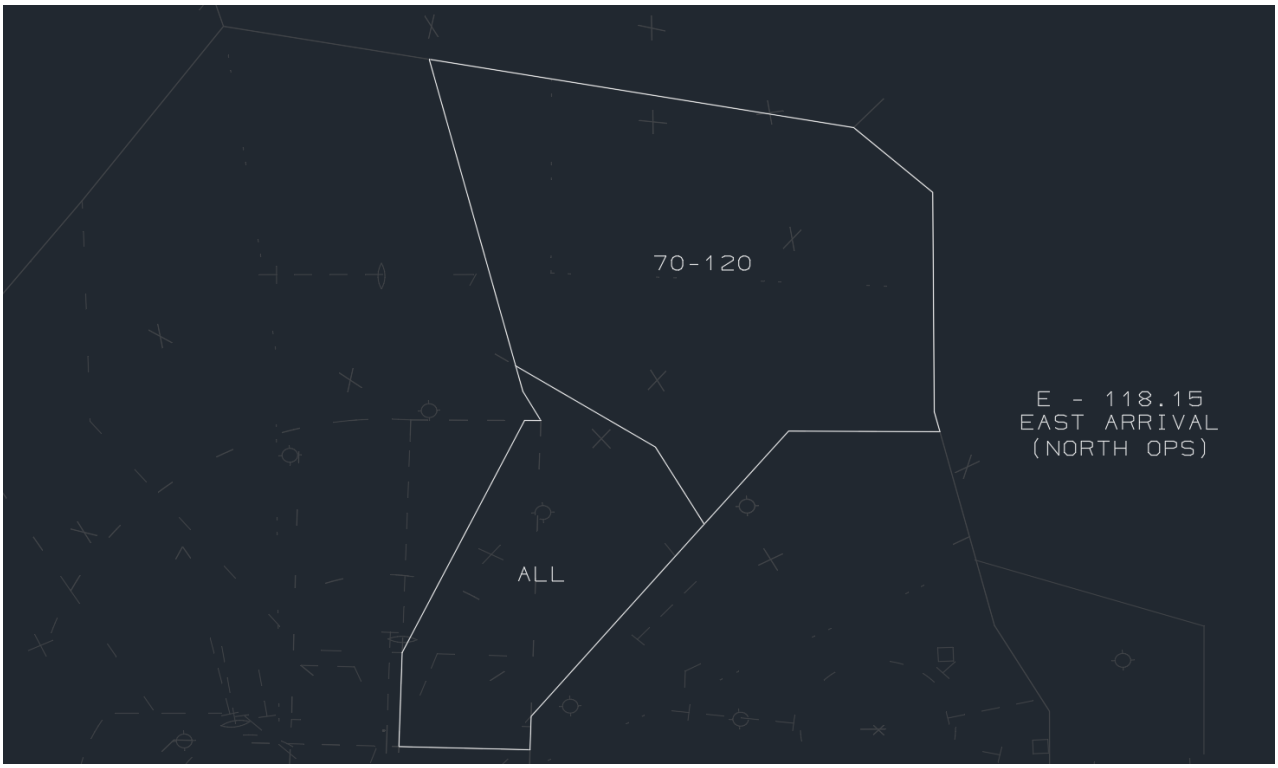

Figure 6 – East Arrival (E) – Tampa North

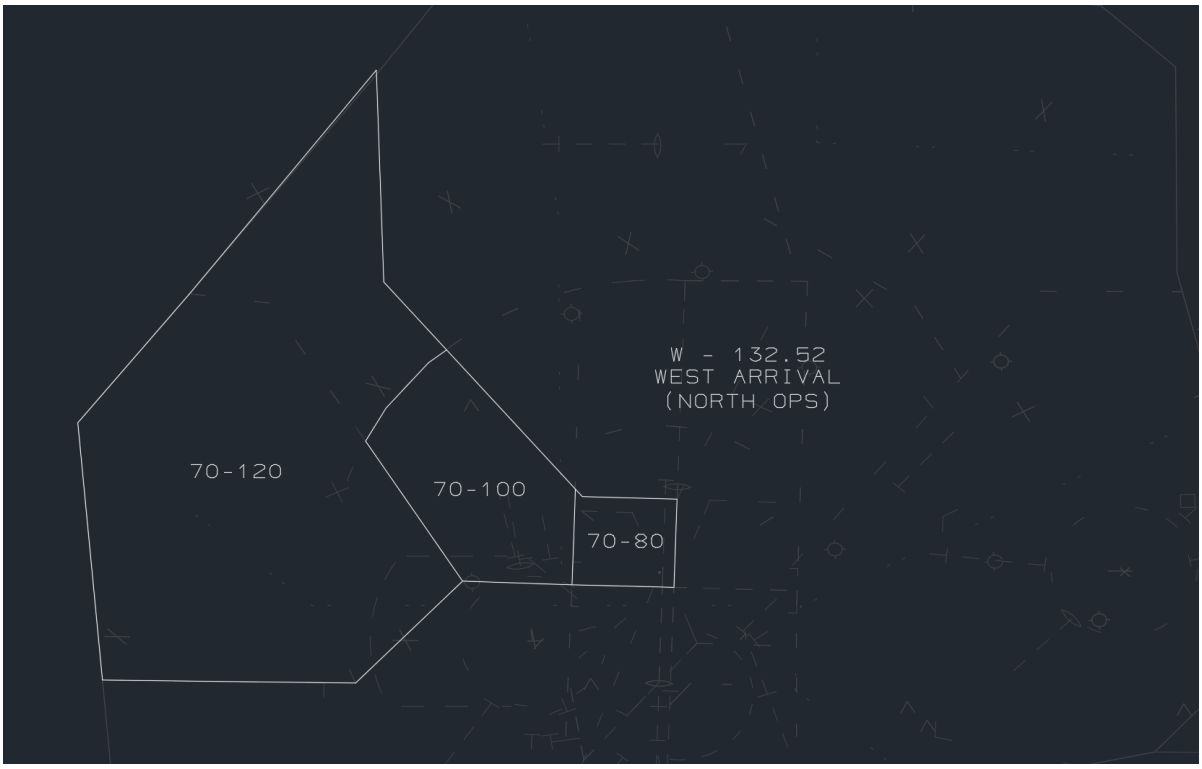

Figure 7 – West Arrival (W) – Tampa North

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Figure 8 – South Departure (G) – Tampa North

Figure 9 – West Departure (D) – Tampa North

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Figure 10 – North Satellite (P) – Tampa North

Figure 11 – South Satellite (S) – Tampa North

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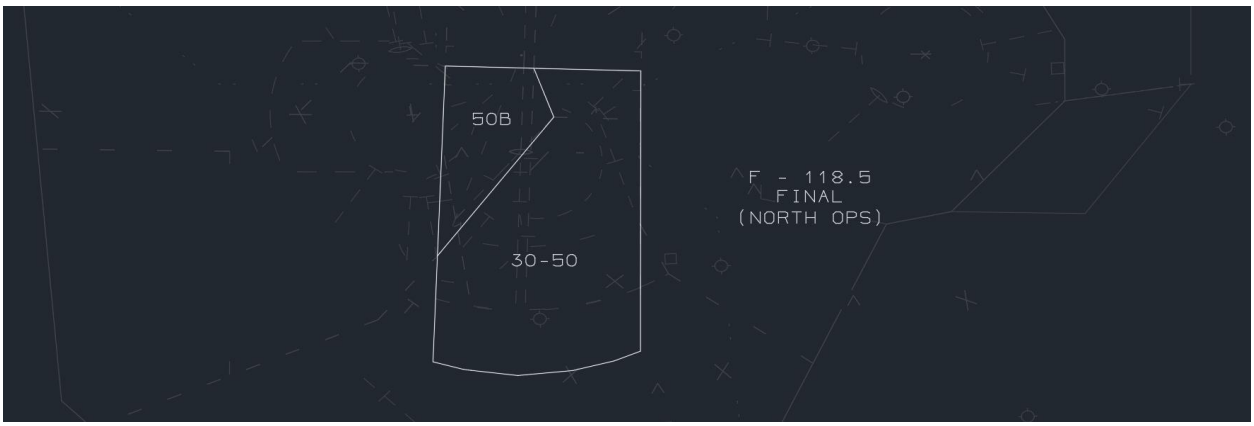

Figure 12 – Final (F) – Tampa North

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Figure 13 – East Arrival (E) – Tampa South

Figure 14 – West Arrival (W) – Tampa South

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Figure 15 – South Departure (G) – Tampa South

Figure 16 – West Departure (D) – Tampa South

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Figure 17 – North Satellite (P) – Tampa South

Figure 18 – South Satellite (S) – Tampa South

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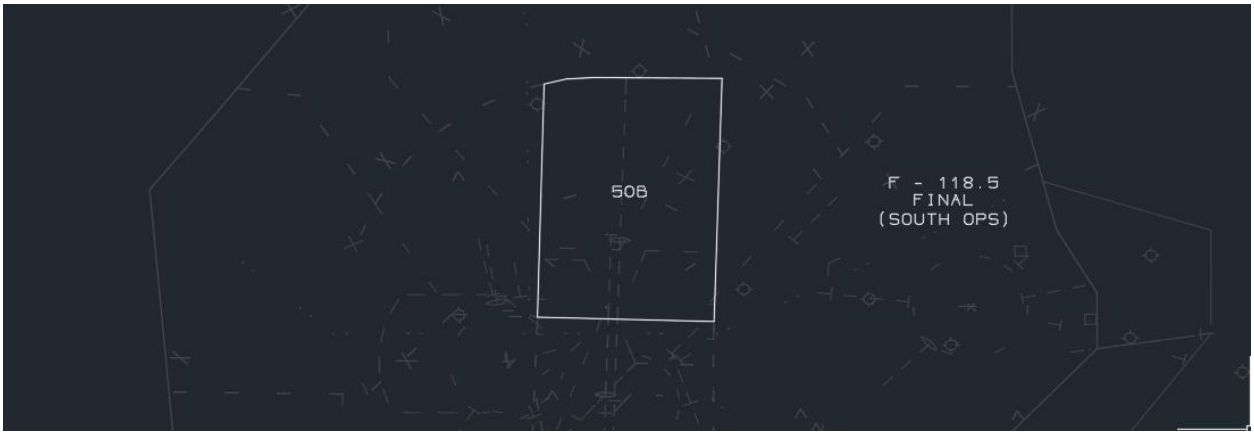

Figure 19 – Final (F) – Tampa South

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